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KBTX News at Noon(Recurring)

By [Lillian Kosh](#)

Published: Sep. 25, 2026 at 3:49 AM UTC | Updated: 10 hours ago



COLLEGE STATION, Texas (KBTX) - College Station City Council voted 4-2 Thursday night to renew the city's contract with Flock Safety, keeping the city's network of 84 license plate reading cameras in operation.

The vote came after a lengthy public comment session with more than 25 residents signing up to speak. The overwhelming concerns over privacy were cited by many.

With Mayor John N. Williams' support, only six council members were in favor, including a 3-3 tie, would have been enough to pass the contract.

In the end, council member William Wright voted against it, while Mayor Pro Tem David White voted in favor.

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David White credited local advocacy groups for helping shape his understanding of the technology. White ultimately voted yes, but said he'd push for guardrails, including possibly cutting back on the city's camera count and adding an independent audit.

Council member Scott Schafer voted yes, but admitted the rollout moved too fast. He called for stricter guardrails in the future, saying he wants the technology used "in a way that's more agreeable" to residents concerned about privacy.

Council member Melissa McIlhaney also voted yes, saying that even if the technology only helped in one case, it would be worth keeping for now.

Council member Mark Smith was one of two who voted no.

"The flock basically adds to the public sense that their privacy is being invaded," he said, arguing that unlike other data collection residents already live with, "this is an easier thing to stop."

Council member Bob Yancy was the second to vote no, arguing the company itself was

uses inflexible contract language and marketing doublespeak.”

Finally, Mayor Pro Tem William Wright capped off the votes to renew the contract. He justified his decision by saying he answers to the entire city, not just those in the room.

“Ultimately, elected a slice of it, you do

After the vote, the c pushing for the city

“Obviously, it’s a pre know John, Ivan an every two weeks, v a pretty disappointing for the community.”

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nd while y’all are

had spent hours e up the fight.

lock BCS. “I ng, showing up members. And it’s o keep fighting

College Station signed its original contract with Flock Safety in September 2025, with the first cameras installed the following month. The renewed contract is valued at nearly \$400,000 a year.

Cities across Texas have moved in the opposite direction in recent months, with several municipalities, including Bastrop, Robinson and Manvel, canceling or declining to renew their own Flock contracts amid growing concerns over privacy and data sharing.

With the contract renewed, College Station’s Flock camera network will continue operating for at least another year, as city leaders say they intend to work with police on additional safeguards going forward.

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Shipley Do-Nuts honor employee



▶ Snapchat tip leads to school custodian's arrest on child pornography charges

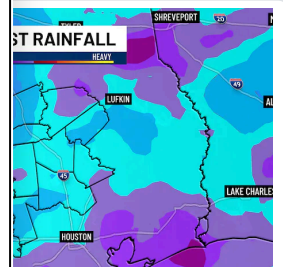


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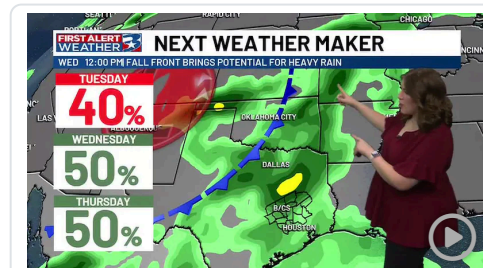
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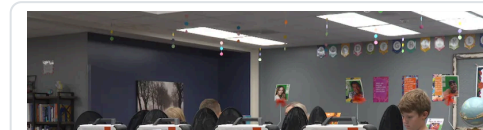
WEEKEND GARDENER

GARDEN EXPLORATION DAYS

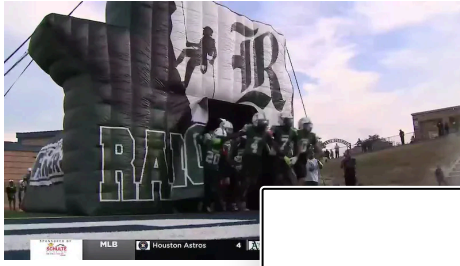
▶ Weekend Gardener: Garden Exploration Days



Seasonable mornings and toasty afternoons through the weekend.



▶ Grimes County brings official voting machines for student council elections

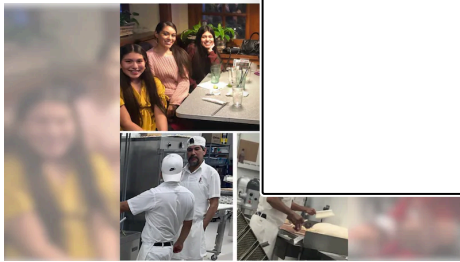


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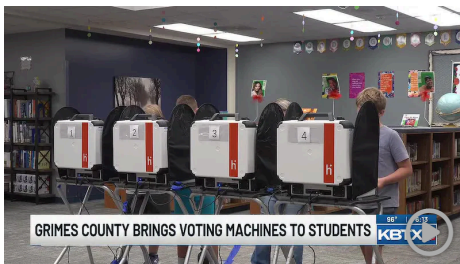


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Grimes County brings official voting machines for student council elections

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